Maureen Gallery Kovacs, *The Epic of Gilgamesh* (1989) – Tablet XI (online edition)

- **Translator:** Maureen Gallery Kovacs
- **Print edition:** Stanford University Press, 1989 (2nd ed. with corrections, 1989). Still in print, ~USD 20–25 paperback.
- **Online edition:** "Electronic Edition by Wolf Carnahan, 1998", Academy for Ancient Texts: http://www.ancienttexts.org/library/mesopotamian/gilgamesh/tab11.htm. The live site did not answer on 2026-10-16, so it was fetched from the Wayback Machine: `https://web.archive.org/web/2022id_/http://www.ancienttexts.org/library/mesopotamian/gilgamesh/tab11.htm`.
- **Retrieved:** 2026-10-16
- **License / copyright: COPYRIGHTED** (© 1985, 1989 Board of Trustees of the Leland Stanford Junior University). The online edition circulates freely, but I could not verify any permission from the rights holder. Use only for private comparison and do not redistribute. A full-text upload at archive.org/details/epic-of-gilgamesh (mis-dated 1928) is an unauthorized patron upload and was not used.

Files

- `ancienttexts_tab11.raw.html`: raw HTML.
- `tablet-XI.md`: clean extraction, one verse line per output line.

Line numbering

The online text has **no line numbers**. Kovacs's verse lines are close to one-to-one with the Akkadian lines of Thompson's numbering, which is behind George by up to ~10 lines in the 190s–200s. Livius.org reproduces this translation with line markers `[11.n]`, so use `../Livius/tablet-XI.md` to locate lines.

Assessment

A clear, sober, literal-leaning modern prose-verse translation, the standard US classroom translation before George 1999. It predates George's critical edition, so it has older restorations, older name forms (Utanapishtim, Shuruppak, Ubartutu, Mt. Nimush/Nisir) and gaps that are now filled. It is useful as a plain-English comparison but is superseded by George 1999/2003/eBL.